

Appendix N — Wider Founding Team CVs

Supporting Appendix to the DEQUAD UKES Submission

Beyond the two named co-founders (Yusuf Quadri, CEO; Yusuff Adeagbo, CTO), DEQUAD is joined at incorporation by three senior team members who bring deep functional expertise across marketing, engineering and programme delivery.

None of the team is currently drawing a salary. Each has accepted an EMI share-option grant and is contributing time on a pure-equity basis pending the close of the pre-seed round in September Year 1. This is a material signal of belief in the mission and materially strengthens the leadership profile without adding to cash burn.

N.1 — Dr Gerald Marfo · Chief Marketing Officer

Field	Value
Role at DEQUAD	Chief Marketing Officer (founding team member)
Working pattern Y1	Equity-only — no Y1 salary ; salaried role to commence after seed close (Q2 Y2)
Cash investment	£0 — joining as senior team member, not as a share-capital founder
Equity	EMI options with 4-year vest, 1-year cliff

Summary

Dr Gerald Marfo holds a **PhD in Digital Marketing** and brings academic-level rigour to DEQUAD's marketing strategy. His remit covers brand positioning, the UK go-to-market plan (universities and students in parallel), measurement frameworks (CAC, LTV, conversion analytics) and channel selection across organic, paid, content and partnerships.

Why this matters for DEQUAD

- DEQUAD operates a two-sided market — universities (B2B) and students (B2C). A PhD-credentialled CMO is uniquely placed to design measurement that ties consumer-funnel signals back to institutional-buyer outcomes.
- Universities now require evidenced wellbeing strategies (UUK Mental Health Charter); Gerald's academic background lends additional credibility in the sales conversation.
- He owns the Y1 marketing-spend allocation across the channels in Section 16 of the business plan.

Responsibilities

- Brand strategy, positioning and messaging architecture
- UK university partnership marketing (PR, events, UUK channel)
- Performance marketing strategy across Instagram, TikTok, Google Search, LinkedIn
- Marketing measurement and dashboarding; CAC discipline
- Mentoring the first marketing hire (Q3 Y2)

N.2 — Adedapo Ajuwon · Senior Software Engineer

Field	Value
Role at DEQUAD	Senior Software Engineer (founding team member)
Working pattern Y1	Equity-only — no Y1 salary ; salaried role to commence Q1 Y2
Cash investment	£0 — joining as senior team member
Equity	EMI options with 4-year vest, 1-year cliff

Summary

Adedapo Ajuwon is a senior software engineer working alongside the CTO on the DEQUAD production stack. He contributes to both backend (FastAPI / MongoDB) and frontend (Expo / React Native universal) development, infrastructure, and operational reliability.

Responsibilities

- Production reliability and performance of the DEQUAD platform

- Feature delivery in collaboration with the CTO — peer matching, mood tracker, safeguarding webhook, admin tooling
- Code review and engineering standards across the team
- Mentoring the next backend engineer hire (Q1 Y2)

N.3 — Chinyere Jennifer · Senior Advisor — Programme & Delivery

Field	Value
Day job	Senior Project Management Consultant, MIGSO-PCUBED (global project, programme and portfolio management consultancy)
Role at DEQUAD	Senior Advisor — Programme & Delivery
Working pattern Y1	Advisory capacity — periodic engagement
Cash investment	£0
Equity	EMI options on a 4-year vest, advisor allocation

Summary

Chinyere Jennifer is a Senior Project Management Consultant at MIGSO-PCUBED, one of the world's leading project / programme / portfolio management consultancies (a Capgemini company). She works with large enterprise clients on programme governance, risk and delivery assurance. She also has an applied background in **Large Language Model (LLM)** technology, giving DEQUAD an in-house perspective on the safeguarding and inference pipeline.

Responsibilities to DEQUAD

- Programme governance for university pilot rollouts
- Quarterly risk-register review challenge (see Risk Register, Governance section)
- LLM safety and evaluation input to the safeguarding triage model
- Introduction to MIGSO-PCUBED's enterprise network for B2B pilot acceleration

Why this matters for endorsement

For UKES, the wider team materially strengthens the **viability** evidence:

Dimension	Evidence
Marketing capability	PhD-credentialled CMO with relevant subject-matter expertise
Engineering depth	CTO + senior software engineer at incorporation — not a solo technical founder
Programme governance	Senior consultant from a global PMO firm advising on delivery quality
AI / LLM credibility	Advisor with LLM background — directly relevant to safeguarding inference
Diversity	Founding team is 100% Black-British / African-diaspora — under-represented in UK tech, but central to the student population DEQUAD serves

Three appointments to a founding team alongside two co-founders is unusually deep for a pre-revenue UK startup and is itself evidence of the team's ability to attract talent on belief in the mission.

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